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Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMMAD BIN ZAYED RECEIVES JORDAN KING

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan receives King Abdullah II of Jordan at Al Bateen Airport yesterday. The Jordan King arrived in Abu Dhabi on a fraternal visit to the UAE. Shaikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court, was also present to welcome the Jordan King.

124,000 displaced in Gaza in few days as Israel steps up offensive

Israel issues evacuation orders in Jabalia after Beit Lahia and Beit Hanoun

GAZA

The United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees (UNRWA) has reported that approximately 124,000 people have been displaced in Gaza in recent days due to ongoing Israeli bombardment.

Families, the agency said, are carrying what little they have, with no shelter and nowhere to go. UNRWA added that food supplies have become scarce and prices have surged, describing the situation in the Strip as a "humanitarian tragedy."

On Monday, an Israeli air strike killed a journalist working with Al Jazeera and the military



Hamdan Ballal

issued fresh calls to evacuate parts of Gaza's north, as Israel pressed its renewed bombardment and ground operations in the Palestinian territory.

Israeli police, meanwhile, said it had released Oscar-winning Palestinian director Hamdan Ballal in the occupied West Bank after briefly detaining him.

Israel resumed intense air strikes across Gaza last Tues-

day, followed by ground operations, after talks on extending a ceasefire with the Palestinian militant group Hamas reached an impasse. On Monday evening, Israeli military spokesman Avichay Adraee issued "an early warning before a strike" in the northern area of Jabalia.

"Terrorist organisations are once again returning to and firing rockets from populated areas... For your safety, head south toward the known shelters immediately," Adraee said on X, after issuing similar warnings for the northern towns of Beit Lahia and Beit Hanoun.

The health ministry in Hamas-run Gaza said yesterday that 792 people had been killed in the week since Israel resumed bombardments on the Palestinian territory, including 62 in the past 24 hours.

— Agencies
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PALESTINIAN OSCAR
WINNER RELEASED: SEE P17

Jail, up to Dh200,000 fines under new UAE traffic laws

Severe penalties for driving under influence of narcotics or psychotropic drugs

ABU DHABI
BY ALI AL HAMMADI
Reporter

The new Federal Traffic Law, to be introduced across the country from March 29, introduces severe penalties for serious traffic violations, including imprisonment and fines of up to Dh200,000 for individuals caught driving under the influence of narcotic substances or psychotropic drugs.

Anyone found guilty of driving or attempting to drive while under the influence of such substances will face a minimum fine of Dh30,000 and a maximum of Dh200,000, along with imprisonment. Additionally, courts are required to suspend the driver's licence for a

minimum of six months for the first offence, one year for a second offence, and permanently revoke it for the third offence.

Licence offences

If a motorist is caught driving without a valid licence, Article 37 sets out penalties. A first-time offender driving with an unrecognised foreign licence faces a fine of Dh2,000 to Dh10,000. A repeat offender faces three months' imprisonment and a fine of Dh5,000 to Dh50,000.

Driving without a valid UAE licence carries a penalty of up to three months' imprisonment and a fine of Dh5,000 to Dh50,000. In case of repeat offences, penalties increase to a minimum of three months in jail and a fine between Dh20,000 and Dh100,000.

Any driver who unintentionally causes the death of a person while operating a vehicle will face imprisonment and a fine of no less than Dh50,000.
SEE ALSO P2

UAE ranks 2nd among safest nations globally

COUNTRY ALSO IN 2ND SPOT AMONG NATIONS WITH LOWEST CRIME RATE

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE has been ranked the second safest country in the world, with an impressive safety index score of 84.5, according to the 2025 Safety Index by Numbeo. Andorra secured the top spot with a score of 84.7, while Qatar claimed third place, followed by Taiwan in fourth.

GCC countries have dominated this year's rankings, with Oman joining Qatar in the top five by securing the fifth position globally. Saudi Arabia and Bahrain also ranked among the Top-20 countries, placing in 14th and 16th spots, respectively.

In addition, the UAE ranked as the country with the second-lowest crime rate in the 2025 Crime Index by Numbeo, further reinforcing its reputation as one of the safest nations worldwide.

US, UK in bottom half

Numbeo's data is derived from surveys conducted by its users, with questions modelled after scientific and government surveys.

These surveys evaluate perceptions of crime levels, safety concerns, and experiences with property and violent crimes to compile the safety and crime indices.

WORLD'S TOP-10 SAFEST NATIONS

Country	Score
1. Andorra	84.7
2. UAE	84.5
3. Qatar	84.2
4. Taiwan	82.9
5. Oman	81.7
6. Isle of Man	79.0
7. Hong Kong	78.5
8. Armenia	77.9
9. Singapore	77.4
10. Japan	77.1

The United States is ranked a lowly 89th among safest countries, while United Kingdom did just a little better at 87th.

Palestine ahead of Pakistan, India

Among Asian nations, Philippines is ranked at 63rd with Pakistan 65th, India 66th and Bangladesh 126th.

Interestingly, Palestine is ranked at 61st spot, while Israel is ranked 34th in the safety rankings.

Among the bottom five countries, South Africa is ranked at 143rd, Afghanistan at 144th, Haiti at 145th, Papua New Guinea at 146th and Venezuela props up the list at 147th.

SPECIAL REPORT

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BUSINESS

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SPORT

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